

Following up on Continent 8's planning-team referral

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

Mar 2 VP Network forwarded your Chicago map to planning	22 Continent 8 leads in Wave C	2 Chicago sites you cited (350 E Cermak, TierPoint Polk)	0 planning-team contacts identified
STAGE Wave C prospect, with a warm referral from March. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Continent 8 (Wave C), 22 leads	LAST TOUCH Sep 29-30: 'the diversity gap in what you resell' to new leads; calls to CTO and Network Architect	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: reply to Philippe Gagne's March thread

Bottom line

This account already has the warmest reply on your book outside OCC, and it's sitting in March. On **Mar 2, Philippe Gagne (VP, Network) wrote that he forwarded your email and Chicago map to Continent 8's planning team** 'so they can consider your network the next time they need something in the area'. Your outreach cited Continent 8's Chicago sites at **Digital Realty CHI (350 E Cermak) and TierPoint Chicago (Polk St)**, both places Crosstown is on- or near-net. Since then, Wave C has grown to 22 people worldwide, which buries that referral. The plan: go back to Gagne, ask who in planning received the map, and cut the sequence to the people who plan the US network.

What Continent 8 is, in one analogy

Continent 8 is the armored-car service for online casinos and sportsbooks: it hosts and connects regulated gaming platforms inside each state's borders. Every new state license is a new branch, and each branch needs two separate roads in.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Mar 2, 2026: Philippe Gagne forwarded your email and Chicago map to the planning team	HubSpot email history	Warm referral. Follow it up by name.
Continent 8 operates in Digital Realty CHI (350 E Cermak) and TierPoint Chicago (Polk) per your March outreach	HubSpot email history	Two sites, both on Crosstown's footprint.
Cris Kuehl commentary on AI deployment in gaming (Sep 8)	ZoomInfo scoop	Thought-leadership only.
Mariano Banares (Senior Network Engineer) shows a reply timestamp Sep 29 in HubSpot, not in the Lemlist inbox	HubSpot	Probably an auto-reply; check.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Feb 23, 2026	Personal email	'Supporting Continent 8's Chicago Network Connectivity' to Philippe Gagne	-
Mar 2, 2026	Follow-up + reply	You cited DLR 350 E Cermak and TierPoint Polk; Gagne replied he forwarded it with your map to planning	Warm referral
Sep 10-28	Wave C, 3 emails	To CTO Edward O'Connor and Network Architect Adam Augustyn	No replies
Sep 28-30	Wave C, 20 new leads	Network engineers and NOC staff worldwide; 'the diversity gap in what you resell'	List too wide
Sep 29	Phone	Calls to O'Connor and Augustyn (Ireland)	No notes
Oct 1	Call (Wave C)	Spoke with Abhishek: not responsible for Chicago network operations; relationship formed	Send the promised follow-up email

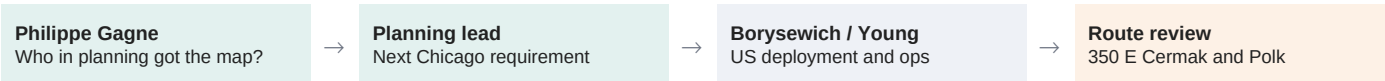
Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Philippe Gagne	VP, Network (HubSpot)	Montreal (514)	Already forwarded your map. Ask who in planning has it.	Replied Mar 2. Not in Wave C
Angus Young	Director, Network Operations (HubSpot)	UK	Senior network ops owner.	Added Sep 28; step skipped
Nicolas Borysewich	Manager, Data Center Operations Deployment (Apollo)	Las Vegas	US deployment lead.	Not contacted. nicolas.borysewich@continent8.com (verified)
Adam Augustyn	Network Architect (HubSpot)	Ireland	Designs the network.	3 emails + call
Edward O'Connor	CTO (HubSpot)	Ireland	Executive. Hold.	3 emails + call

Not worth chasing for this goal

Remove the ~15 NOC analysts and engineers added Sep 28 from Wave C; they create noise and risk annoying the team Gagne referred you to.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Philippe Gagne VP, Network

Why them: He already helped once. Make the next step easy.

Channel: Email reply in the March thread, Mon Oct 5 | Subject: RE: Supporting Continent 8's Chicago Network Connectivity

Philippe, thanks again for passing our Chicago map to your planning team in March. Could you share who on that team I should keep in touch with? I'd like to send them an updated map covering 350 E Cermak and TierPoint on Polk, and stay out of everyone else's inbox.

2. Nicolas Borysewich Manager, Data Center Operations Deployment

Why them: US deployments; second door.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 12 | Subject: Chicago deployments

Nicolas, Philippe Gagne shared our Chicago fiber map with Continent 8's planning team earlier this year. Are any new US deployments coming that touch Chicago? If so, I'd like to make sure your team has our current routes.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Send Abhishek the promised follow-up email with Crosstown info; ask who owns Chicago network.	Referral path.
Fri Oct 2	Cut Wave C to O'Connor, Augustyn, Young; remove the rest.	Protect the referral.
Mon Oct 5	Reply to Philippe Gagne in the March thread.	-
Thu Oct 8	Check Mariano Banares' Sep 29 'reply' in HubSpot; handle if real.	-
Mon Oct 12	Email Nicolas Borysewich (mention Gagne only after he replies, or keep it general).	-
Week of Oct 19	Send the updated KMZ to the planning contact.	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: route review for 350 E Cermak and Polk.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 9	Planning contact named	HubSpot contact added
Oct 30	Route review held or requirement identified	Logged

Guardrails

- Mention Philippe Gagne to others only after he agrees.
- Credits used: 1 Apollo person enrichment; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot email history (Feb 23, Mar 2, 2026) including Philippe Gagne's reply; Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Continent 8 (Wave C)'; ZoomInfo scoop (Sep 8); Apollo people data (Oct 1, 2026).